

Soul, Immortality and Rebirth — MCQ Solutions

Option-specific solutions and trap analysis

Every option is diagnosed separately. Correct positions were independently randomized and then audited for distribution, runs and visible cues.

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MCQ 1

On the six survival-terms, which statement is correct?

A. Immortality and survival make exactly the same claim. B. Rebirth is a wider term than reincarnation. C. Liberation is simply a synonym for heaven. D. Resurrection is a form of transmigration.

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — scope overstatement. The option claims “Immortality and survival make exactly the same claim.” The governing correction is: Rebirth (esp. Buddhist punarbhava) is the wider term; reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed, resurrection is one life, and liberation is exit from the cycle, not heaven. - **B:** Correct. Rebirth (esp. Buddhist punarbhava) is the wider term; reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed, resurrection is one life, and liberation is exit from the cycle, not heaven. - **C:** Incorrect — scope overstatement. The option claims “Liberation is simply a synonym for heaven.” The governing correction is: Rebirth (esp. Buddhist punarbhava) is the wider term; reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed, resurrection is one life, and liberation is exit from the cycle, not heaven. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Resurrection is a form of transmigration.” The governing correction is: Rebirth (esp. Buddhist punarbhava) is the wider term; reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed, resurrection is one life, and liberation is exit from the cycle, not heaven.

Examiner trap: scope overstatement. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Rebirth (esp. Buddhist punarbhava) is the wider term; reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed, resurrection is one life, and liberation is exit from the cycle, not heaven. **Coverage mapping:** C01 PYQ **linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 2

Which relation between substantial-soul immortality and rebirth is philosophically defensible?

A. It is neither sufficient by itself nor necessary. B. It is sufficient by itself but not necessary. C. It is necessary but insufficient by itself. D. It is both necessary and sufficient.

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. Immortality can identify a continuity bearer, but rebirth additionally needs a transmigration or re-embodiment doctrine; Buddhist causal continuity also shows that a substantial immortal soul is not necessary. - **B:** Incorrect — it treats survival as if it already entailed another embodiment. The option claims “It is sufficient by itself but not necessary.” Immortality alone does not supply a rebirth mechanism. - **C:** Incorrect — Buddhism rejects the alleged necessity, and immortality alone still does not establish re-embodiment. The option claims “It is necessary but insufficient by itself.” - **D:** Incorrect — it overstates both directions. The option claims “It is both necessary and sufficient.” Buddhist rebirth denies necessity, while the need for an additional transmigration account denies sufficiency.

Examiner trap: confusing survival after death with entry into another embodiment. **Repair action:** State both limits: an immortal soul may bear continuity only inside an additional transmigration or re-embodiment doctrine, and Buddhist continuity shows that such a soul is not necessary. **Coverage mapping:** C03 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 3

The decisive counter-example to 'rebirth requires an immortal soul' is:

A. Jainism B. Nyaya-Vaisesika C. Buddhism D. Advaita Vedanta

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims "Jainism" The governing correction is: Buddhism affirms rebirth (punarbhava) while denying a permanent self (anatman). - **B:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims "Nyaya-Vaisesika" The governing correction is: Buddhism affirms rebirth (punarbhava) while denying a permanent self (anatman). - **C:** Correct. Buddhism affirms rebirth (punarbhava) while denying a permanent self (anatman). - **D:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims "Advaita Vedanta" The governing correction is: Buddhism affirms rebirth (punarbhava) while denying a permanent self (anatman).

Examiner trap: doctrinal misattribution. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Buddhism affirms rebirth (punarbhava) while denying a permanent self (anatman). **Coverage mapping:** C04 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 4

Calling 'liberation' a family-resemblance term means:

A. It lacks any shared use across philosophical schools. B. It covers distinct destinations linked by overlapping concerns. C. It names precisely the same state in every school. D. It always denotes personal union with a creator-God.

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims "It lacks any shared use across philosophical schools." The governing correction is: Identity, communion, cessation, isolation and perfected individuality share the label 'liberation' without sharing one content. - **B:** Correct. Identity, communion, cessation, isolation and perfected individuality share the label 'liberation' without sharing one content. - **C:** Incorrect — collapsed distinction. The option claims "It names precisely the same state in every school." The governing correction is: Identity, communion, cessation, isolation and perfected individuality share the label 'liberation' without sharing one content. - **D:** Incorrect — scope overstatement. The option claims "It always denotes personal union with a creator-God." The governing correction is: Identity, communion, cessation, isolation and perfected individuality share the label 'liberation' without sharing one content.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Identity, communion, cessation, isolation and perfected individuality share the label 'liberation' without sharing one content. **Coverage mapping:** C01 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 5

Plato's recollection (anamnesis) argument most directly establishes:

A. bodily resurrection B. the soul's post-mortem survival on its own C. the soul's pre-existence D. the mortality of the body

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “bodily resurrection” The governing correction is: Recollection infers that the soul knew the Forms before birth -- pre-existence, which is not yet post-mortem survival. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “the soul's post-mortem survival on its own” The governing correction is: Recollection infers that the soul knew the Forms before birth -- pre-existence, which is not yet post-mortem survival. - **C:** Correct. Recollection infers that the soul knew the Forms before birth -- pre-existence, which is not yet post-mortem survival. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “the mortality of the body” The governing correction is: Recollection infers that the soul knew the Forms before birth -- pre-existence, which is not yet post-mortem survival.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Recollection infers that the soul knew the Forms before birth -- pre-existence, which is not yet post-mortem survival. **Coverage mapping:** C03 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 6

Which is Plato's culminating ('final') argument in the Phaedo?

A. The affinity argument based on likeness to the Forms. B. The cyclical argument based on generation from opposites. C. The final argument based on the Form of Life. D. The recollection argument based on knowledge before birth.

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The affinity argument based on likeness to the Forms.” The governing correction is: The final argument holds that the soul essentially brings Life and so cannot admit its opposite, death. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The cyclical argument based on generation from opposites.” The governing correction is: The final argument holds that the soul essentially brings Life and so cannot admit its opposite, death. - **C:** Correct. The final argument holds that the soul essentially brings Life and so cannot admit its opposite, death. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The recollection argument based on knowledge before birth.” The governing correction is: The final argument holds that the soul essentially brings Life and so cannot admit its opposite, death.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: The final argument holds that the soul essentially brings Life and so cannot admit its opposite, death. **Coverage mapping:** C03 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 7

Simmias objects to Plato that the soul is:

A. a harmony/attunement of the body B. identical with the Forms C. immortal by affinity to the Forms D. a simple substance

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. The harmony objection makes the soul depend on the body; Plato replies the soul rules the body and pre-exists it. - **B:** Incorrect — collapsed distinction. The option claims “identical with the Forms” The governing correction is: The harmony objection makes the soul depend on the body; Plato replies the soul rules the body and pre-exists it. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “immortal by affinity to the Forms” The governing correction is: The harmony objection makes the soul depend on the body; Plato replies the soul rules the body and pre-exists it. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “a simple substance” The governing correction is: The harmony objection makes the soul depend on the body; Plato replies the soul rules the body and pre-exists it.

Examiner trap: collapsed distinction. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: The harmony objection makes the soul depend on the body; Plato replies the soul rules the body and pre-exists it. **Coverage mapping:** C03 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 8

Kant's paralogism, applied to immortality, shows that:

A. The soul's permanence cannot be demonstrated as substantial. B. The soul's survival follows directly from recollected knowledge. C. The soul is known theoretically as an enduring substance. D. The soul is established empirically as a material entity.

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. Kant denies that the soul is a knowable substance, so its indestructibility cannot be proved a priori. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The soul's survival follows directly from recollected knowledge.” The governing correction is: Kant denies that the soul is a knowable substance, so its indestructibility cannot be proved a priori. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The soul is known theoretically as an enduring substance.” The governing correction is: Kant denies that the soul is a knowable substance, so its indestructibility cannot be proved a priori. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The soul is established empirically as a material entity.” The governing correction is: Kant denies that the soul is a knowable substance, so its indestructibility cannot be proved a priori.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Kant denies that the soul is a knowable substance, so its indestructibility cannot be proved a priori. **Coverage mapping:** C03 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 9

The three kinds of karma are:

A. asrava, bandha and nirjara B. sancita, prarabdha and agami C. jnana, karma and bhakti D. sattva, rajas and tamas

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “asrava, bandha and nirjara” The governing correction is: Sancita (stored), prarabdha (now ripening) and agami (future) classify karmic debt. - **B:** Correct. Sancita (stored), prarabdha (now ripening) and agami (future) classify karmic debt. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “jnana, karma and bhakti” The governing correction is: Sancita (stored), prarabdha (now ripening) and agami (future) classify karmic debt. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “sattva, rajas and tamas” The governing correction is: Sancita (stored), prarabdha (now ripening) and agami (future) classify karmic debt.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Sancita (stored), prarabdha (now ripening) and agami (future) classify karmic debt. **Coverage mapping:** C04 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 10

Rebirth is significant in karma theory chiefly because it:

A. It cancels responsibility once the present life ends. B. It preserves conscious memory of every previous embodiment. C. It lets karmic consequences mature beyond one lifetime. D. It demonstrates a divine distributor of karmic rewards.

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “It cancels responsibility once the present life ends.” The governing correction is: Desert outruns a single life, so rebirth is the field where karmic fruits ripen. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “It preserves conscious memory of every previous embodiment.” The governing correction is: Desert outruns a single life, so rebirth is the field where karmic fruits ripen. - **C:** Correct. Desert outruns a single life, so rebirth is the field where karmic fruits ripen. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “It demonstrates a divine distributor of karmic rewards.” The governing correction is: Desert outruns a single life, so rebirth is the field where karmic fruits ripen.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Desert outruns a single life, so rebirth is the field where karmic fruits ripen. **Coverage mapping:** C04 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 11

The claim that karma is NOT fatalism rests on:

A. Present effort operates within inherited karmic conditions. B. Unseen karmic force determines every action without remainder. C. Maturing past karma eliminates all present moral choice. D. The subtle body fixes every future action in advance.

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. Personal effort (purusakara) works within the given (daiva); present effort shapes future (agami) karma. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Unseen karmic force determines every action without remainder.” The governing correction is: Personal effort (purusakara) works within the given (daiva); present effort shapes future (agami) karma. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Maturing past karma eliminates all present moral choice.” The governing correction is: Personal effort (purusakara) works within the given (daiva); present effort shapes future (agami) karma. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The subtle body fixes every future action in advance.” The governing correction is: Personal effort (purusakara) works within the given (daiva); present effort shapes future (agami) karma.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Personal effort (purusakara) works within the given (daiva); present effort shapes future (agami) karma. **Coverage mapping:** C04 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 12

Gita 9.21 (return from heaven once merit is exhausted) shows that:

A. Karmic action has no reality after bodily death. B. Heaven constitutes the final release from saṃsāra. C. Bodily resurrection takes place after heavenly enjoyment. D. Heaven remains a temporary stage within saṃsāra.

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Karmic action has no reality after bodily death.” The governing correction is: Heavenly sojourn ends in return to the mortal world, so it is inside samsara. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Heaven constitutes the final release from saṃsāra.” The governing correction is: Heavenly sojourn ends in return to the mortal world, so it is inside samsara. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Bodily resurrection takes place after heavenly enjoyment.” The governing correction is: Heavenly sojourn ends in return to the mortal world, so it is inside samsara. - **D:** Correct. Heavenly sojourn ends in return to the mortal world, so it is inside samsara.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Heavenly sojourn ends in return to the mortal world, so it is inside samsara. **Coverage mapping:** C11 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 13

In Buddhism, what is 'reborn' is best described as:

A. An eternal ātman carrying unchanged personal identity. B. A resurrected body restored by divine action. C. A dependently arisen stream of causally linked events. D. A permanent substance migrating intact between bodies.

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims "An eternal ātman carrying unchanged personal identity." The governing correction is: Rebirth is causal continuity of dependently arisen aggregates, not a soul. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims "A resurrected body restored by divine action." The governing correction is: Rebirth is causal continuity of dependently arisen aggregates, not a soul. - **C:** Correct. Rebirth is causal continuity of dependently arisen aggregates, not a soul. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims "A permanent substance migrating intact between bodies." The governing correction is: Rebirth is causal continuity of dependently arisen aggregates, not a soul.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Rebirth is causal continuity of dependently arisen aggregates, not a soul. **Coverage mapping:** C05 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 14

'Neither the same nor wholly other' answers the objection that:

A. Whether Buddhist analysis collapses into complete nihilism. B. Whether the flame illustration demonstrates rebirth conclusively. C. Who receives karmic fruits if no self persists. D. Whether anātman abolishes all conventional personal reference.

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims "Whether Buddhist analysis collapses into complete nihilism." The governing correction is: The later stream is causally descended from the earlier -- enough for moral responsibility without substance-identity. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims "Whether the flame illustration demonstrates rebirth conclusively." The governing correction is: The later stream is causally descended from the earlier -- enough for moral responsibility without substance-identity. - **C:** Correct. The later stream is causally descended from the earlier -- enough for moral responsibility without substance-identity. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims "Whether anātman abolishes all conventional personal reference." The governing correction is: The later stream is causally descended from the earlier -- enough for moral responsibility without substance-identity.

Examiner trap: doctrinal misattribution. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: The later stream is causally descended from the earlier -- enough for moral responsibility without substance-identity. **Coverage mapping:** C11 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 15

The flame-to-flame illustration is properly used as:

A. A model of continuity without strict numerical identity. B. Empirical evidence for an immaterial and immortal soul. C. A demonstrative proof that rebirth actually occurs. D. A demonstrative proof that no self exists.

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. It illustrates a continuity-model; it is never a demonstration. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Empirical evidence for an immaterial and immortal soul.” The governing correction is: It illustrates a continuity-model; it is never a demonstration. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “A demonstrative proof that rebirth actually occurs.” The governing correction is: It illustrates a continuity-model; it is never a demonstration. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “A demonstrative proof that no self exists.” The governing correction is: It illustrates a continuity-model; it is never a demonstration.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: It illustrates a continuity-model; it is never a demonstration. **Coverage mapping:** C05 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 16

The philosophical significance of the anti-theistic stand on rebirth is that rebirth is shown to be:

A. Logically impossible unless a creator directs the process. B. Coherent without either creator-God or soul-substance. C. Dependent on an immortal bearer governed by God. D. Conceptually identical with bodily resurrection after death.

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Logically impossible unless a creator directs the process.” The governing correction is: Buddhism (and Jainism) run karma-rebirth-liberation without a judging God or a transmigrating substance. - **B:** Correct. Buddhism (and Jainism) run karma-rebirth-liberation without a judging God or a transmigrating substance. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Dependent on an immortal bearer governed by God.” The governing correction is: Buddhism (and Jainism) run karma-rebirth-liberation without a judging God or a transmigrating substance. - **D:** Incorrect — collapsed distinction. The option claims “Conceptually identical with bodily resurrection after death.” The governing correction is: Buddhism (and Jainism) run karma-rebirth-liberation without a judging God or a transmigrating substance.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Buddhism (and Jainism) run karma-rebirth-liberation without a judging God or a transmigrating substance. **Coverage mapping:** C04 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 17

In Nyaya apavarga, consciousness in the liberated state is:

A. absent B. omniscient C. infinite bliss D. non-dual awareness

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. Consciousness is adventitious to the Nyaya self, so apavarga ends pain and consciousness alike -- a negative state. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “omniscient” The governing correction is: Consciousness is adventitious to the Nyaya self, so apavarga ends pain and consciousness alike -- a negative state. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “infinite bliss” The governing correction is: Consciousness is adventitious to the Nyaya self, so apavarga ends pain and consciousness alike -- a negative state. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “non-dual awareness” The governing correction is: Consciousness is adventitious to the Nyaya self, so apavarga ends pain and consciousness alike -- a negative state.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Consciousness is adventitious to the Nyaya self, so apavarga ends pain and consciousness alike - a negative state. **Coverage mapping:** C08 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 18

Which pair correctly matches liberation-term to school?

A. nirvana -- Jainism B. kaivalya -- Advaita C. apavarga -- Nyaya-Vaisesika D. moksa -- Buddhism

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “nirvana -- Jainism” The governing correction is: Apavarga is the Nyaya-Vaisesika term; kaivalya is Samkhya-Yoga, nirvana is Buddhist, and Buddhism does not use moksa in the Vedantic sense. - **B:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “kaivalya -- Advaita” The governing correction is: Apavarga is the Nyaya-Vaisesika term; kaivalya is Samkhya-Yoga, nirvana is Buddhist, and Buddhism does not use moksa in the Vedantic sense. - **C:** Correct. Apavarga is the Nyaya-Vaisesika term; kaivalya is Samkhya-Yoga, nirvana is Buddhist, and Buddhism does not use moksa in the Vedantic sense. - **D:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “moksa -- Buddhism” The governing correction is: Apavarga is the Nyaya-Vaisesika term; kaivalya is Samkhya-Yoga, nirvana is Buddhist, and Buddhism does not use moksa in the Vedantic sense.

Examiner trap: doctrinal misattribution. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Apavarga is the Nyaya-Vaisesika term; kaivalya is Samkhya-Yoga, nirvana is Buddhist, and Buddhism does not use moksa in the Vedantic sense. **Coverage mapping:** C01 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 19

Jivanmukti differs from videhamukti in that jivanmukti is:

A. the resurrection of the person B. liberation only after death C. liberation of the body itself D. liberation attained while still embodied

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “the resurrection of the person” The governing correction is: Jivanmukti is freedom while living; videhamukti is at the body's fall. - **B:** Incorrect — scope overstatement. The option claims “liberation only after death” The governing correction is: Jivanmukti is freedom while living; videhamukti is at the body's fall. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “liberation of the body itself” The governing correction is: Jivanmukti is freedom while living; videhamukti is at the body's fall. - **D:** Correct. Jivanmukti is freedom while living; videhamukti is at the body's fall.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Jivanmukti is freedom while living; videhamukti is at the body's fall. **Coverage mapping:** C07 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 20

Griffiths' formula that Advaitic moksa is 'not acquired but acknowledged' means:

A. Mokṣa is acquired later as a heavenly reward. B. Knowledge removes error about an already-free self. C. Ritual action produces mokṣa as a new result. D. Bodily resurrection discloses the self's prior freedom.

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Mokṣa is acquired later as a heavenly reward.” The governing correction is: Bondage is avidya/adhyasa, so knowledge only removes the superimposition. - **B:** Correct. Bondage is avidya/adhyasa, so knowledge only removes the superimposition. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Ritual action produces mokṣa as a new result.” The governing correction is: Bondage is avidya/adhyasa, so knowledge only removes the superimposition. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Bodily resurrection discloses the self's prior freedom.” The governing correction is: Bondage is avidya/adhyasa, so knowledge only removes the superimposition.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Bondage is avidya/adhyasa, so knowledge only removes the superimposition. **Coverage mapping:** C06 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 21

For Viśiṣṭadvaita, in liberation the jīva:

A. The jīva is extinguished when bondage finally ends. B. The jīva persists without awareness or divine relation. C. The jīva persists eternally in communion with God. D. The jīva becomes numerically identical with Brahman.

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The jīva is extinguished when bondage finally ends.” The governing correction is: The jīva is an eternal mode of God, freed into service/communion, never becoming God. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The jīva persists without awareness or divine relation.” The governing correction is: The jīva is an eternal mode of God, freed into service/communion, never becoming God. - **C:** Correct. The jīva is an eternal mode of God, freed into service/communion, never becoming God. - **D:** Incorrect — collapsed distinction. The option claims “The jīva becomes numerically identical with Brahman.” The governing correction is: The jīva is an eternal mode of God, freed into service/communion, never becoming God.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: The jīva is an eternal mode of God, freed into service/communion, never becoming God.

Coverage mapping: C07 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 22

The 'real agent' problem is a difficulty primarily for:

A. Advaita B. Visistadvaita C. Nyaya D. Jainism

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. If ultimate individuality is denied, Advaita must explain who is bound and freed; it appeals to conventional agency until insight. - **B:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “Visistadvaita” The governing correction is: If ultimate individuality is denied, Advaita must explain who is bound and freed; it appeals to conventional agency until insight. - **C:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “Nyaya” The governing correction is: If ultimate individuality is denied, Advaita must explain who is bound and freed; it appeals to conventional agency until insight. - **D:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “Jainism” The governing correction is: If ultimate individuality is denied, Advaita must explain who is bound and freed; it appeals to conventional agency until insight.

Examiner trap: doctrinal misattribution. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: If ultimate individuality is denied, Advaita must explain who is bound and freed; it appeals to conventional agency until insight. **Coverage mapping:** C11 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 23

In Advaita, bondage is fundamentally:

A. avidya, a beginningless superimposition (adhyasa) B. karmic matter clinging to the soul C. dependence on God D. the isolation of purusa from prakrti

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. Bondage is ignorance -- the rope-snake superimposition -- removable only by knowledge. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “karmic matter clinging to the soul” The governing correction is: Bondage is ignorance -- the rope-snake superimposition -- removable only by knowledge. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims

“dependence on God” The governing correction is: Bondage is ignorance -- the rope-snake superimposition -- removable only by knowledge. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “the isolation of purusa from prakrti” The governing correction is: Bondage is ignorance -- the rope-snake superimposition -- removable only by knowledge.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Bondage is ignorance -- the rope-snake superimposition -- removable only by knowledge.

Coverage mapping: C06 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 24

For Sankara, the direct means to liberation is:

A. Ritual action that produces liberation as its result. B. Knowledge that removes the ignorance constituting bondage. C. Devotional surrender accepted as an independent direct means. D. Karmic action performed without any need for knowledge.

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Ritual action that produces liberation as its result.” The governing correction is: Since liberation is the removal of avidya, only knowledge removes it; Sankara rejects jnana-karma-samuccaya. - **B:** Correct. Since liberation is the removal of avidya, only knowledge removes it; Sankara rejects jnana-karma-samuccaya. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Devotional surrender accepted as an independent direct means.” The governing correction is: Since liberation is the removal of avidya, only knowledge removes it; Sankara rejects jnana-karma-samuccaya. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Karmic action performed without any need for knowledge.” The governing correction is: Since liberation is the removal of avidya, only knowledge removes it; Sankara rejects jnana-karma-samuccaya.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Since liberation is the removal of avidya, only knowledge removes it; Sankara rejects jnana-karma-samuccaya. **Coverage mapping:** C01 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 25

In Jainism, the influx of karmic matter into the soul is called:

A. samvara B. bandha C. nirjara D. asrava

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “samvara” The governing correction is: Asrava is influx; bandha is bondage, samvara is stoppage, nirjara is shedding. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “bandha” The governing correction is: Asrava is influx; bandha is bondage, samvara is stoppage, nirjara is shedding. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “nirjara” The governing correction is: Asrava is influx; bandha is bondage, samvara is stoppage, nirjara is shedding. - **D:** Correct. Asrava is influx; bandha is bondage, samvara is stoppage, nirjara is shedding.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Asrava is influx; bandha is bondage, samvara is stoppage, nirjara is shedding. **Coverage mapping:** C07 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 26

The stoppage of fresh karmic influx is:

A. nirjara B. kevala C. asrava D. samvara

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “nirjara” The governing correction is: Samvara halts new influx; nirjara then sheds accumulated matter. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “kevala” The governing correction is: Samvara halts new influx; nirjara then sheds accumulated matter. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “asrava” The governing correction is: Samvara halts new influx; nirjara then sheds accumulated matter. - **D:** Correct. Samvara halts new influx; nirjara then sheds accumulated matter.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Samvara halts new influx; nirjara then sheds accumulated matter. **Coverage mapping:** C11 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 27

Jain liberation is best described as:

A. perfected omniscient individuality B. cessation of the causal stream C. identity with Brahman D. contentless isolation of purusa

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. The freed jiva manifests ananta-catustaya (infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, energy) -- individuality perfected, not dissolved. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “cessation of the causal stream” The governing correction is: The freed jiva manifests ananta-catustaya (infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, energy) -- individuality perfected, not dissolved. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “identity with Brahman” The governing correction is: The freed jiva manifests ananta-catustaya (infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, energy) -- individuality perfected, not dissolved. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “contentless isolation of purusa” The governing correction is: The freed jiva manifests ananta-catustaya (infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, energy) -- individuality perfected, not dissolved.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: The freed jiva manifests ananta-catustaya (infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, energy) -- individuality perfected, not dissolved. **Coverage mapping:** C07 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 28

Jain kevala differs from Samkhya kaivalya because Jain kevala means:

A. cessation of consciousness B. contentless isolation C. omniscience (kevala-jnana) D. union with a personal God

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “cessation of consciousness” The governing correction is: Same syllable, opposite content: Jain kevala is omniscience; Samkhya kaivalya is contentless isolation. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “contentless isolation” The governing correction is: Same syllable, opposite content: Jain kevala is omniscience; Samkhya kaivalya is contentless isolation. - **C:** Correct. Same syllable, opposite content: Jain kevala is omniscience; Samkhya kaivalya is contentless isolation. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “union with a personal God” The governing correction is: Same syllable, opposite content: Jain kevala is omniscience; Samkhya kaivalya is contentless isolation.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Same syllable, opposite content: Jain kevala is omniscience; Samkhya kaivalya is contentless isolation. **Coverage mapping:** C07 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 29

Samkhya-karika 62-63 states that, strictly, what is bound and released is:

A. purusa, not prakrti B. the individual buddhi acting alone C. prakrti, not purusa D. Isvara

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “purusa, not prakrti” The governing correction is: No purusa is bound, released or transmigrating; prakrti binds and releases herself -- the misattribution is the whole doctrine. - **B:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “the individual buddhi acting alone” The governing correction is: No purusa is bound, released or transmigrating; prakrti binds and releases herself -- the misattribution is the whole doctrine. - **C:** Correct. No purusa is bound, released or transmigrating; prakrti binds and releases herself -- the misattribution is the whole doctrine. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Isvara” The governing correction is: No purusa is bound, released or transmigrating; prakrti binds and releases herself -- the misattribution is the whole doctrine.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: No purusa is bound, released or transmigrating; prakrti binds and releases herself -- the misattribution is the whole doctrine. **Coverage mapping:** C08 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 30

The potter's-wheel image (SK 67) illustrates:

A. Īśvara continuing creation after discriminative knowledge arises. B. Embodied life continuing through residual karmic momentum. C. Plural puruṣas continuing because each possesses a body. D. World-production continuing through prakṛti's creative activity.

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Īśvara continuing creation after discriminative knowledge arises.” The governing correction is: The wheel spins on after the hand withdraws -- like the body after viveka-khyati; it parallels Advaita's prarabdha image. - **B:** Correct. The wheel spins on after the hand withdraws -- like the body after viveka-khyati; it parallels Advaita's prarabdha image. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Plural puruṣas continuing because each possesses a body.” The governing correction is: The wheel spins on after the hand withdraws -- like the body after viveka-khyati; it parallels Advaita's prarabdha image. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “World-production continuing through prakṛti's creative activity.” The governing correction is: The wheel spins on after the hand withdraws -- like the body after viveka-khyati; it parallels Advaita's prarabdha image.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: The wheel spins on after the hand withdraws -- like the body after viveka-khyati; it parallels Advaita's prarabdha image. **Coverage mapping:** C11 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 31

Yoga-sutra 1.24 characterises Isvara as:

A. a special purusa untouched by karma B. identical with prakṛti C. the material cause of the world D. the karmic judge of souls

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. Isvara is a special purusa, object of pranidhana -- theism without creation. - **B:** Incorrect — collapsed distinction. The option claims “identical with prakṛti” The governing correction is: Isvara is a special purusa, object of pranidhana -- theism without creation. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “the material cause of the world” The governing correction is: Isvara is a special purusa, object of pranidhana -- theism without creation. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “the karmic judge of souls” The governing correction is: Isvara is a special purusa, object of pranidhana -- theism without creation.

Examiner trap: collapsed distinction. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Isvara is a special purusa, object of pranidhana -- theism without creation. **Coverage mapping:** C08 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 32

Samkhya-Yoga kaivalya is best described as:

A. Non-dual identity of the individual self with Brahman. B. Eternal communion of the individual soul with God. C. Isolation of pure consciousness from all material content. D. Omniscient perfection of an eternally individual soul.

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Non-dual identity of the individual self with Brahman.” The governing correction is: Kaivalya is aloneness -- purusa standing in its own nature, explicitly not bliss. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Eternal communion of the individual soul with God.” The governing correction is: Kaivalya is aloneness -- purusa standing in its own nature, explicitly not bliss. - **C:** Correct. Kaivalya is aloneness -- purusa standing in its own nature, explicitly not bliss. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Omniscient perfection of an eternally individual soul.” The governing correction is: Kaivalya is aloneness -- purusa standing in its own nature, explicitly not bliss.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Kaivalya is aloneness -- purusa standing in its own nature, explicitly not bliss. **Coverage mapping:** C08 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 33

The nine limbs of devotion (navadha bhakti) are enumerated in:

A. Bhagavad Gītā 18.66 in the surrender teaching. B. Bhāgavata Purāṇa 7.5.23 in Prahlāda's teaching. C. Sāṃkhya-kārikā 62 in the bondage discussion. D. Yoga-sūtra 1.24 in the Īśvara definition.

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Bhagavad Gītā 18.66 in the surrender teaching.” The governing correction is: Bhagavata 7.5.23 lists sravana, kirtana, smarana, pada-sevana, arcana, vandana, dasya, sakhya, atma-nivedana. - **B:** Correct. Bhagavata 7.5.23 lists sravana, kirtana, smarana, pada-sevana, arcana, vandana, dasya, sakhya, atma-nivedana. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Sāṃkhya-kārikā 62 in the bondage discussion.” The governing correction is: Bhagavata 7.5.23 lists sravana, kirtana, smarana, pada-sevana, arcana, vandana, dasya, sakhya, atma-nivedana. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Yoga-sūtra 1.24 in the Īśvara definition.” The governing correction is: Bhagavata 7.5.23 lists sravana, kirtana, smarana, pada-sevana, arcana, vandana, dasya, sakhya, atma-nivedana.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Bhagavata 7.5.23 lists sravana, kirtana, smarana, pada-sevana, arcana, vandana, dasya, sakhya, atma-nivedana. **Coverage mapping:** C09 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 34

Sankara rejects jnana-karma-samuccaya because he holds that liberation is:

A. Liberation is attained through ritual action alone. B. Liberation is produced as a result of action. C. Liberation requires a graded combination of equal means. D. Liberation removes ignorance rather than producing freedom.

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Liberation is attained through ritual action alone.” The governing correction is: On the removal model, only knowledge dispels avidya; action merely purifies. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Liberation is produced as a result of action.” The governing correction is: On the removal model, only knowledge dispels avidya; action merely purifies. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Liberation requires a graded combination of equal means.” The governing correction is: On the removal model, only knowledge dispels avidya; action merely purifies. - **D:** Correct. On the removal model, only knowledge dispels avidya; action merely purifies.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: On the removal model, only knowledge dispels avidya; action merely purifies. **Coverage mapping:** C09 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 35

The marjara-nyaya versus markata-nyaya dispute concerns:

A. How karmic action should be defined across schools. B. How divine grace relates to the aspirant's effort. C. How many distinct puruṣas Sāṃkhya must accept. D. Whether the experienced world possesses ultimate reality.

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “How karmic action should be defined across schools.” The governing correction is: Cat-hold (grace alone) versus monkey-hold (grace plus effort) is the tradition's own statement of the grace-effort problem. - **B:** Correct. Cat-hold (grace alone) versus monkey-hold (grace plus effort) is the tradition's own statement of the grace-effort problem. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “How many distinct puruṣas Sāṃkhya must accept.” The governing correction is: Cat-hold (grace alone) versus monkey-hold (grace plus effort) is the tradition's own statement of the grace-effort problem. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Whether the experienced world possesses ultimate reality.” The governing correction is: Cat-hold (grace alone) versus monkey-hold (grace plus effort) is the tradition's own statement of the grace-effort problem.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Cat-hold (grace alone) versus monkey-hold (grace plus effort) is the tradition's own statement of the grace-effort problem. **Coverage mapping:** C08 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 36

The Vivekacudamani definition of bhakti should be attributed to:

A. The Advaita tradition, because personal authorship remains disputed. B. Madhva, because knowledge-grounded devotion defines his path. C. Rāmānuja, because sustained remembrance defines his bhakti. D. Śaṅkara personally, because the attribution is historically certain.

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. Provenance discipline: say 'the Advaita tradition', never 'Sankara wrote'. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Madhva, because knowledge-grounded devotion defines his path.” The governing correction is: Provenance discipline: say 'the Advaita tradition', never 'Sankara wrote'. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Rāmānuja, because sustained remembrance defines his bhakti.” The governing correction is: Provenance discipline: say 'the Advaita tradition', never 'Sankara wrote'. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Śaṅkara personally, because the attribution is historically certain.” The governing correction is: Provenance discipline: say 'the Advaita tradition', never 'Sankara wrote'.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Provenance discipline: say 'the Advaita tradition', never 'Sankara wrote'. **Coverage mapping:** C09 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 37

Oscar Cullmann (1955) argues that immortality of the soul and resurrection of the dead are:

A. both Greek in origin B. theologically opposed, not complementary C. two names for one doctrine D. both forms of rebirth

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “both Greek in origin” The governing correction is: Cullmann's thesis is that the Greek and Hebrew-Christian conceptions are opposed. - **B:** Correct. Cullmann's thesis is that the Greek and Hebrew-Christian conceptions are opposed. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “two names for one doctrine” The governing correction is: Cullmann's thesis is that the Greek and Hebrew-Christian conceptions are opposed. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “both forms of rebirth” The governing correction is: Cullmann's thesis is that the Greek and Hebrew-Christian conceptions are opposed.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Cullmann's thesis is that the Greek and Hebrew-Christian conceptions are opposed. **Coverage mapping:** C03 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 38

'Reincarnation', in careful usage, differs from 'rebirth' because reincarnation:

A. is the wider, more neutral term B. presupposes a substantial soul re-entering flesh C. denies any continuity between lives D. applies straightforwardly to Buddhism

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “is the wider, more neutral term” The governing correction is: Reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed; rebirth is wider and the only correct term for Buddhism. - **B:** Correct. Reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed; rebirth is wider and the only correct term for Buddhism. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “denies any continuity between lives” The governing correction is: Reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed; rebirth is wider and the only correct term for Buddhism. - **D:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “applies straightforwardly to Buddhism” The governing correction is: Reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed; rebirth is wider and the only correct term for Buddhism.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Reincarnation assumes a substance re-enfleshed; rebirth is wider and the only correct term for Buddhism. **Coverage mapping:** C04 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 39

Hick's replica theory is best presented as:

A. a thought-experiment defence of resurrection identity B. a Vedantic doctrine of liberation C. a proof of the soul's natural immortality D. a denial of personal identity

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. An exact, unique psychophysical replica is argued to be the same person; the duplication objection is the standard reply. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “a Vedantic doctrine of liberation” The governing correction is: An exact, unique psychophysical replica is argued to be the same person; the duplication objection is the standard reply. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “a proof of the soul's natural immortality” The governing correction is: An exact, unique psychophysical replica is argued to be the same person; the duplication objection is the standard reply. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “a denial of personal identity” The governing correction is: An exact, unique psychophysical replica is argued to be the same person; the duplication objection is the standard reply.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: An exact, unique psychophysical replica is argued to be the same person; the duplication objection is the standard reply. **Coverage mapping:** C10 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 40

Which reply to the resurrection re-assembly problem is correctly paired?

A. Aquinas -- an exact replica in another space B. Cullmann -- God substitutes a simulacrum C. Hick -- the soul is the form of the body D. van Inwagen -- God preserves a core of the body

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Aquinas -- an exact replica in another space” The governing correction is: Aquinas = soul as form; Hick = replica; van Inwagen = God preserves a core or leaves a simulacrum. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Cullmann -- God substitutes a simulacrum” The governing correction is: Aquinas = soul as form; Hick = replica; van Inwagen = God preserves a core or leaves a simulacrum. - **C:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “Hick -- the soul is the form of the body” The governing correction is: Aquinas = soul as form; Hick = replica; van Inwagen = God preserves a core or leaves a simulacrum. - **D:** Correct. Aquinas = soul as form; Hick = replica; van Inwagen = God preserves a core or leaves a simulacrum.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Aquinas = soul as form; Hick = replica; van Inwagen = God preserves a core or leaves a simulacrum. **Coverage mapping:** C10 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 41

A common error is to say Buddhism denies continuity. Correctly, Buddhism denies:

A. A permanent substance-self, while retaining causal continuity. B. Moral responsibility, while retaining a permanent substance-self. C. Rebirth itself, while retaining karmic causation in one life. D. Causation itself, while retaining conventional personal identity.

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. Anatman denies a permanent self, while the causal stream secures continuity. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Moral responsibility, while retaining a permanent substance-self.” The governing correction is: Anatman denies a permanent self, while the causal stream secures continuity. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Rebirth itself, while retaining karmic causation in one life.” The governing correction is: Anatman denies a permanent self, while the causal stream secures continuity. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Causation itself, while retaining conventional personal identity.” The governing correction is: Anatman denies a permanent self, while the causal stream secures continuity.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Anatman denies a permanent self, while the causal stream secures continuity. **Coverage mapping:** C05 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 42

A frequent trap calls Nyaya apavarga 'positive bliss'. Correctly, apavarga is:

A. Isolation of puruṣa from the operations of prakṛti. B. Eternal communion of a conscious jīva with God. C. Omniscient perfection of an individual liberated jīva. D. Cessation of pain and cognition-producing qualities while self-substance remains.

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — this is Sāṃkhya kaivalya, not Nyāya apavarga. The option claims “Isolation of puruṣa from the operations of prakṛti.” Nyāya retains the self-substance after pain and cognition-producing qualities cease. - **B:** Incorrect — this describes a theistic communion model. The option claims “Eternal communion of a conscious jīva with God.” Nyāya apavarga is not conscious beatitude. - **C:** Incorrect — this describes Jain perfected individuality. The option claims “Omniscient perfection of an individual liberated jīva.” Nyāya denies cognition in the liberated condition. - **D:** Correct. Nyāya apavarga ends pain and the qualities that produce cognition while the self-substance remains.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** State all three elements: pain ceases, cognition-producing qualities cease, and the self-substance remains. **Coverage mapping:** C08 PYQ **linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 43

Students merge kaivalya and kevala. In Samkhya kaivalya is ; *in Jainism kevala is* :

A. communion; identity B. omniscience; contentless isolation C. contentless isolation; omniscience D. bliss; cessation

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “communion; identity” The governing correction is: Same syllable, opposite content -- Samkhya isolation versus Jain omniscience. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “omniscience; contentless isolation” The governing correction is: Same syllable, opposite content -- Samkhya isolation versus Jain omniscience. - **C:** Correct. Same syllable, opposite content -- Samkhya isolation versus Jain omniscience. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “bliss; cessation” The governing correction is: Same syllable, opposite content -- Samkhya isolation versus Jain omniscience.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Same syllable, opposite content -- Samkhya isolation versus Jain omniscience. **Coverage mapping:** C07 PYQ **linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 44

It is wrong to say 'Advaita rejects bhakti'. Advaita treats bhakti as:

A. Wholly irrelevant to liberation or spiritual qualification. B. A fifth puruṣārtha ranked above liberation itself. C. The direct remover of ignorance in place of knowledge. D. Preparatory purification that qualifies the seeker for knowledge.

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Wholly irrelevant to liberation or spiritual qualification.” The governing correction is: Bhakti is a difference of ROLE, not of value: it purifies and qualifies, and jnana alone removes ignorance. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “A fifth puruṣārtha ranked above liberation itself.” The governing correction is: Bhakti is a difference of ROLE, not of value: it purifies and qualifies, and jnana alone removes ignorance. -

C: Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The direct remover of ignorance in place of knowledge.” The governing correction is: Bhakti is a difference of ROLE, not of value: it purifies and qualifies, and jnana alone removes ignorance. - **D:** Correct. Bhakti is a difference of ROLE, not of value: it purifies and qualifies, and jnana alone removes ignorance.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Bhakti is a difference of ROLE, not of value: it purifies and qualifies, and jnana alone removes ignorance. **Coverage mapping:** C09 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 45

Which option presents a non-theistic liberation model that does not retain an enduring self?

A. Nyāya retains a self-substance after pain and cognition cease. B. Viśiṣṭādvaita retains the eternal jīva in communion with God. C. Advaita realizes the identity of ātman and Brahman through knowledge. D. Buddhism ends craving without positing an enduring self.

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — Nyāya is non-theistic in this account of release, but it retains an enduring self-substance. The option claims “Nyāya retains a self-substance after pain and cognition cease.” - **B:** Incorrect — Viśiṣṭādvaita is theistic and preserves an eternal individual jīva. The option claims “Viśiṣṭādvaita retains the eternal jīva in communion with God.” - **C:** Incorrect — Advaita denies ultimate individuality but retains ātman/Brahman identity rather than the no-self model asked for. The option claims “Advaita realizes the identity of ātman and Brahman through knowledge.” - **D:** Correct. Buddhism presents liberation as cessation of craving and ignorance without a creator-God or an enduring self.

Examiner trap: selecting a non-theistic school that nevertheless retains an enduring self. **Repair action:** Match both conditions in the stem: non-theistic liberation and no enduring self. **Coverage mapping:** C01 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 46

Presenting resurrection as 'rebirth in heaven' is wrong because resurrection is:

A. One embodied life restored by divine action for judgement. B. Many lives generated by karma maturing across embodiments. C. A beginningless series sustained by karmic causal continuity. D. Release from saṃsāra through ending karmic bondage.

Answer: A

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct. Resurrection is the opposite structure to samsara: linear, eschatological, and divinely enacted. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Many lives generated by karma maturing across embodiments.” The governing correction is: Resurrection is the opposite structure to samsara: linear, eschatological, and divinely enacted. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “A beginningless series sustained by karmic causal continuity.” The governing correction is: Resurrection is the opposite structure to samsara: linear, eschatological, and

divinely enacted. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Release from saṃsāra through ending karmic bondage.” The governing correction is: Resurrection is the opposite structure to samsara: linear, eschatological, and divinely enacted.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Resurrection is the opposite structure to samsara: linear, eschatological, and divinely enacted.

Coverage mapping: C10 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 47

The 'convergence' reading of jnana/karma/bhakti is best defended by saying they converge in ___ and diverge in ___:

A. text; author B. terminus; function C. grace; effort D. function; terminus

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “text; author” The governing correction is: They converge in function (removing egoic self-appropriation) but diverge in terminus (identity vs communion). - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “terminus; function” The governing correction is: They converge in function (removing egoic self-appropriation) but diverge in terminus (identity vs communion). - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “grace; effort” The governing correction is: They converge in function (removing egoic self-appropriation) but diverge in terminus (identity vs communion). - **D:** Correct. They converge in function (removing egoic self-appropriation) but diverge in terminus (identity vs communion).

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: They converge in function (removing egoic self-appropriation) but diverge in terminus (identity vs communion). **Coverage mapping:** C12 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 48

Calling Yoga's Isvara a 'creator' is a trap; YS 1.24 makes Isvara:

A. The material cause from which the world develops. B. The moral judge who allocates every karmic result. C. The same non-dual reality that Advaita calls Brahman. D. A special puruṣa untouched by affliction and karma.

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The material cause from which the world develops.” The governing correction is: Yoga is the decisive Indian case of theism without creation. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The moral judge who allocates every karmic result.” The governing correction is: Yoga is the decisive Indian case of theism without creation. - **C:** Incorrect — collapsed distinction. The option claims “The same non-dual reality that Advaita calls Brahman.” The governing correction is: Yoga is the decisive Indian case of theism without creation. - **D:** Correct. Yoga is the decisive Indian case of theism without creation.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Yoga is the decisive Indian case of theism without creation. **Coverage mapping:** C12 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 49

Which claim correctly distinguishes numerical from qualitative identity in a survival argument?

A. Both terms mean that later memories resemble earlier memories closely. B. Numerical identity preserves one subject; qualitative identity preserves resemblance. C. Numerical identity preserves exact resemblance; qualitative identity preserves one subject. D. Qualitative identity alone preserves one subject across bodily discontinuity.

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Both terms mean that later memories resemble earlier memories closely.” The governing correction is: Numerical identity concerns being one and the same entity through time; qualitative identity concerns resemblance and can be shared by duplicates. - **B:** Correct. Numerical identity concerns being one and the same entity through time; qualitative identity concerns resemblance and can be shared by duplicates. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Numerical identity preserves exact resemblance; qualitative identity preserves one subject.” The governing correction is: Numerical identity concerns being one and the same entity through time; qualitative identity concerns resemblance and can be shared by duplicates. - **D:** Incorrect — collapsed distinction. The option claims “Qualitative identity alone preserves one subject across bodily discontinuity.” The governing correction is: Numerical identity concerns being one and the same entity through time; qualitative identity concerns resemblance and can be shared by duplicates.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Numerical identity concerns being one and the same entity through time; qualitative identity concerns resemblance and can be shared by duplicates. **Coverage mapping:** C02 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 50

Why is branching a problem for a simple psychological-continuity theory of personal identity?

A. Branching shows that only an immortal substantial soul could survive. B. Two equally continuous successors cannot both be the original person. C. Branching shows that later persons cannot remember earlier experiences. D. Branching shows that psychological continuity ends with bodily change.

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — scope overstatement. The option claims “Branching shows that only an immortal substantial soul could survive.” The governing correction is: Identity is one-to-one and transitive; equal continuity to two successors may preserve survival-like relations but cannot make both the one earlier person. - **B:** Correct. Identity is one-to-one and transitive; equal continuity to two successors may preserve survival-like relations but cannot make both the one earlier person. - **C:** Incorrect

— scope overstatement. The option claims “Branching shows that later persons cannot remember earlier experiences.” The governing correction is: Identity is one-to-one and transitive; equal continuity to two successors may preserve survival-like relations but cannot make both the one earlier person. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Branching shows that psychological continuity ends with bodily change.” The governing correction is: Identity is one-to-one and transitive; equal continuity to two successors may preserve survival-like relations but cannot make both the one earlier person.

Examiner trap: scope overstatement. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Identity is one-to-one and transitive; equal continuity to two successors may preserve survival-like relations but cannot make both the one earlier person. **Coverage mapping:** C02 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 51

What is the central identification-condition pressure on the soul-substance criterion?

A. The criterion must make bodily continuity necessary in every possible case. B. The criterion must reduce resurrection identity to psychological continuity alone. C. The criterion must individuate and re-identify this particular immaterial soul. D. The criterion must deny that any soul could be simple or immaterial.

Answer: C

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — collapsed distinction. The option claims “The criterion must make bodily continuity necessary in every possible case.” The governing correction is: Positing an enduring soul supplies unity only if there is a criterion for picking out and re-identifying that particular soul across bodily discontinuity. - **B:** Incorrect — collapsed distinction. The option claims “The criterion must reduce resurrection identity to psychological continuity alone.” The governing correction is: Positing an enduring soul supplies unity only if there is a criterion for picking out and re-identifying that particular soul across bodily discontinuity. - **C:** Correct. Positing an enduring soul supplies unity only if there is a criterion for picking out and re-identifying that particular soul across bodily discontinuity. - **D:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “The criterion must deny that any soul could be simple or immaterial.” The governing correction is: Positing an enduring soul supplies unity only if there is a criterion for picking out and re-identifying that particular soul across bodily discontinuity.

Examiner trap: collapsed distinction. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Positing an enduring soul supplies unity only if there is a criterion for picking out and re-identifying that particular soul across bodily discontinuity. **Coverage mapping:** C01 **PYQ linkage:** Comparative doctrine transfer.

MCQ 52

In the bounded Strawsonian comparison, why do persons have public identification conditions?

A. Persons are private immaterial egos directly observed by other minds. B. Persons are inferred replicas whose memories alone determine numerical identity. C. Persons are event bundles for which public re-identification is unnecessary. D. Persons are embodied subjects bearing bodily and psychological predicates publicly.

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Persons are private immaterial egos directly observed by other minds.” The governing correction is: Strawson treats the person as a basic embodied particular identified in a public spatio-temporal framework and as the subject of M- and P-predicates. - **B:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Persons are inferred replicas whose memories alone determine numerical identity.” The governing correction is: Strawson treats the person as a basic embodied particular identified in a public spatio-temporal framework and as the subject of M- and P-predicates. - **C:** Incorrect — collapsed distinction. The option claims “Persons are event bundles for which public re-identification is unnecessary.” The governing correction is: Strawson treats the person as a basic embodied particular identified in a public spatio-temporal framework and as the subject of M- and P-predicates. - **D:** Correct. Strawson treats the person as a basic embodied particular identified in a public spatio-temporal framework and as the subject of M- and P-predicates.

Examiner trap: reversed or displaced relation. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Strawson treats the person as a basic embodied particular identified in a public spatio-temporal framework and as the subject of M- and P-predicates. **Coverage mapping:** C02 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 53

What follows from Strawson's identification-condition objection when it is used in this Paper II topic?

A. Divine re-creation automatically produces the numerically identical original person. B. A survival claim must explain who survives and how re-identification works. C. Every rebirth doctrine fails because the preceding body eventually perishes. D. Buddhist causal continuity thereby becomes an enduring Cartesian substance.

Answer: B

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — collapsed distinction. The option claims “Divine re-creation automatically produces the numerically identical original person.” The governing correction is: The comparison is diagnostic rather than a proof of mortality: soul or resurrection theories owe a criterion that selects the same subject. - **B:** Correct. The comparison is diagnostic rather than a proof of mortality: soul or resurrection theories owe a criterion that selects the same subject. - **C:** Incorrect — reversed or displaced relation. The option claims “Every rebirth doctrine fails because the preceding body eventually perishes.” The governing correction is: The comparison is diagnostic rather than a proof of mortality: soul or resurrection theories owe a criterion that selects the same subject. - **D:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “Buddhist causal continuity thereby becomes an enduring Cartesian substance.” The governing correction is: The comparison is diagnostic rather than a proof of mortality: soul or resurrection theories owe a criterion that selects the same subject.

Examiner trap: collapsed distinction. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: The comparison is diagnostic rather than a proof of mortality: soul or resurrection theories owe a criterion that selects the same subject. **Coverage mapping:** C02 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.

MCQ 54

Which statement best connects Buddhist rebirth with the diachronic identity debate?

A. Buddhism converts copied memories into an enduring immortal substance. B. Buddhism rejects causal continuity, karma and conventional persons together. C. Buddhism preserves an unchanging owner beneath the changing aggregates. D. Buddhism uses caused continuity that is neither identical nor wholly other.

Answer: D

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “Buddhism converts copied memories into an enduring immortal substance.” The governing correction is: Dependent origination preserves causal and moral connectedness without asserting a numerically identical permanent self. - **B:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “Buddhism rejects causal continuity, karma and conventional persons together.” The governing correction is: Dependent origination preserves causal and moral connectedness without asserting a numerically identical permanent self. - **C:** Incorrect — doctrinal misattribution. The option claims “Buddhism preserves an unchanging owner beneath the changing aggregates.” The governing correction is: Dependent origination preserves causal and moral connectedness without asserting a numerically identical permanent self. - **D:** Correct. Dependent origination preserves causal and moral connectedness without asserting a numerically identical permanent self.

Examiner trap: doctrinal misattribution. **Repair action:** Re-state the controlling distinction in one sentence: Dependent origination preserves causal and moral connectedness without asserting a numerically identical permanent self. **Coverage mapping:** C02 **PYQ linkage:** Direct survival/identity transfer.